

IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Date	03 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-8740
Project Name	Employee Data Management using ServiceNow Import Sets and Transform Maps
Maximum Marks	

Step 1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

The team began by discussing the difficulties involved in maintaining employee information when data is received in spreadsheet format. The discussion focused on the effort required to enter records manually, the possibility of duplicate employee records, inconsistent updates, and the lack of a single place to verify the imported information. The team agreed to focus on making employee-data intake more structured and easier to maintain within ServiceNow.

Selected Problem Area

Employee data received through Excel spreadsheets needs to be imported into ServiceNow accurately, with existing records updated instead of creating duplicates, while giving administrators a simple way to verify and monitor the imported data.

Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

The following ideas were generated and grouped around data entry, data quality, automation, and reporting.

Idea	Group	Initial Observation
Manual employee data entry	Data Entry	Simple to start, but time-consuming and prone to human error.
ServiceNow Import Set for Excel uploads	Data Import	Provides a staging area for incoming spreadsheet data.
Transform Map for field mapping	Data Transformation	Maps spreadsheet columns to the employee target table.
Coalesce using Employee ID	Data Quality	Identifies existing employees and prevents duplicate records.
Scheduled automated imports	Automation	Could reduce repeated manual uploads for regularly received files.
Validation rules before transformation	Data Quality	Could identify missing or invalid employee information.
Department and location reports	Reporting	Makes imported employee information easier to analyze.
Central employee analytics dashboard	Reporting	Provides a single view of employee distribution and records.

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

The ideas were considered using practical criteria: relevance to the identified problem, ease of implementation in ServiceNow, impact on data accuracy, and usefulness to administrators. The team selected a solution built around Import Sets and Transform Maps, with Coalesce for duplicate prevention and reports/dashboard features for monitoring.

Idea	Problem Fit	Implementation Feasibility	Data Quality Impact	Decision
------	-------------	----------------------------	---------------------	----------

Import Set + Transform Map	High	High	High	Selected
Coalesce with Employee ID	High	High	High	Selected
Reports and Dashboard	High	High	Medium	Selected
Validation rules	Medium	Medium	High	Future enhancement
Scheduled imports	Medium	Medium	Medium	Future enhancement
Manual entry	Low	High	Low	Not selected

Final Ideation Outcome

The ideation phase resulted in a practical ServiceNow solution for importing employee information from spreadsheets. The selected approach supports controlled data loading, field mapping, duplicate prevention and basic reporting. It also leaves room for future improvements such as validation rules and scheduled imports.

Source basis: team project implementation and the supplied Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization template.